Extra, extra, read all about it! 7a

Below is the front page from the local paper in Shaketown, outlining the earthquake that occurred the night before. Read the article then answer the questions that follow.

Shaketown Morning Sun

Earthquake leaves population shaken

(1) Yet another earthquake in Shaketown has left many people shaken. The earthquake occurred last night at 10:45.

(2) Margaret from Bright St said, "I woke up startled. My bedside lamp had fallen off the table and my hanging pictures on the wall were moving around. I was very scared."

(3) Jimmy, living in Black St, and Mary and husband Lee, from around the corner in Church St, commented that they thought the slight trembling last night was a truck travelling down the street.

(4) Shaketown has a detailed earthquake history. The last earthquake was in January 1992, but did not cause much damage. Seismograph stations in Shaketown detected minor tremors, but not many people felt them.

(5) Another earthquake in 1954 left Shaketown damaged. Every building in town was left with some damage. People today fear that one day the 'big quake' will hit.

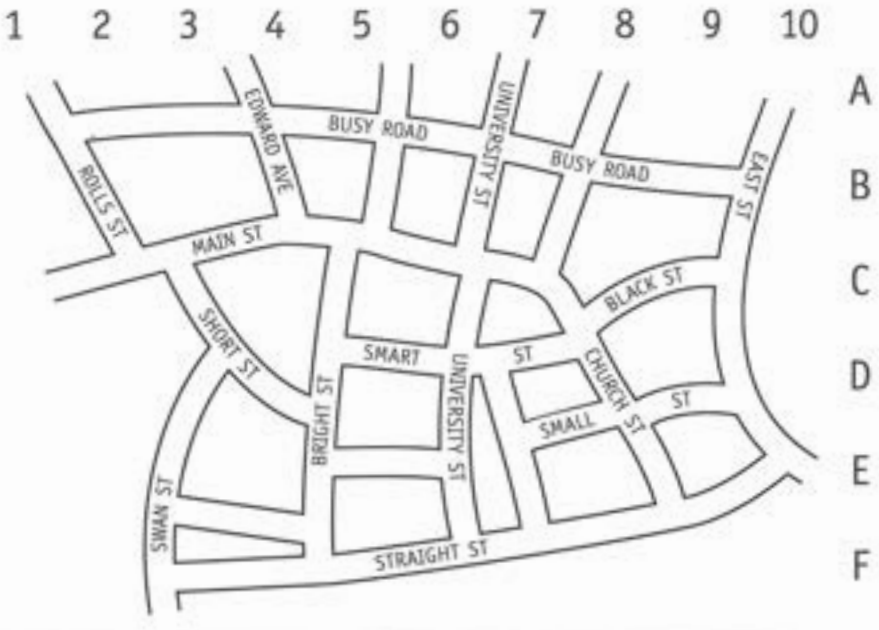
(6) According to Professor Seismo, of Shaketown University, people should be prepared for a major earthquake. "Shaketown sits on top of a fault zone known as a zig-zag fault," he said recently. "It runs right under the town. Our records suggest that there is movement at least once every ten years."

(7) Professor Seismo believes that Shaketown will experience a larger earthquake in the near future but he is not sure when. "We should all take precautions now for a major earthquake."

(8) Last night Professor Seismo was on the balcony of his house in Edward Ave and felt his hanging pot plants swaying. However, his wife inside the house did not notice anything.

(9) Hotel owner Bruce, from Rolls St, told of his frightening ordeal last night. He was about to close the bar, when he heard cracking noises and plaster began to fall off the walls. Many glasses and bottles fell to the ground and shattered. He said, "I ran to the door with difficulty amidst all that noise. I thought the building was going to bury me."

(10) Well-known performer Star, from Swan St, noticed that her pets were behaving strangely last night but did not understand why. They are fine this morning.



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Extra, extra, read all about it! 7b

1 On the map above, find the streets where all the people mentioned in the article live.

Write down the map references below.

a Margaret _____

b Professor Seismo _____

c Jimmy _____

d Bruce _____

e Mary and Lee _____

f Star _____

2 Place the initials of the people on the map to indicate where they live.

3 Using the Modified Mercalli scale work out the MM number for the experience of each eyewitness mentioned in the article. Write the MM number beside the relevant paragraph of the article.

Judging eyewitness accounts

4 The epicenter was found to be east of the town.

Name the person whose account was unreliable. Justify your answer.

_____

_____

_____

_____

Taking precautions

5 Suggest how people could take precautions for a major earthquake. Think about you and your family; think about the whole town.

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